

Sewickley Community Center

Executive Summary

Client

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Student Consulting Team

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Background

Established in 1935, the Sewickley Community Center (SCC) is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit serving over 20 zip codes through recreational, educational, and social programs. Operating with a lean but dedicated staff, SCC manages services including a food pantry, seasonal events, and a community pool. While the organization maintains a solid technology foundation comprising Wix, Bloomerang, and multiple payment gateways, these systems operate independently. As a result, staff rely on manual data transfer and reconciliation, which limits operational capacity and obscures a complete view of constituent engagement.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

SCC's core challenge is that manual administrative workflows scale linearly with participation, consuming approximately 5-10 minutes of staff time per registrant. Data is fragmented across Wix, Bloomerang, Qgiv, PayPal, and Excel, preventing a unified system of record and complicating reporting for operations and grants. The opportunity is to integrate these existing platforms and standardize data practices, unlocking significant staff capacity while reducing errors and improving data reliability.

Project Vision

This project aims to transition SCC from a fragmented, manual data environment to a centralized and partially automated system built on its existing tools. By integrating platforms and standardizing workflows, SCC can reduce administrative workload, improve data visibility, and enable staff to focus on community engagement and service delivery.

Project Outcomes

Our engagement delivered outcomes across technology, process, and people:

- **Technology:** Designed and validated Zapier automation pipeline to automatically create constituent records and log interactions from Wix into Bloomerang. Additionally, transitioned pool attendance tracking to a digital Wix Bookings module.
- **Process:** Standardized payment workflows by integrating PayPal and Venmo into Bloomerang and introduced structured "Appeal" tagging to separate operational revenue from donations.

- **People:** Developed a Technology Adoption Framework that enables staff to make low-cost technical decisions independently while requiring Board oversight for larger investments, improving governance and long-term decision-making.

Together, these changes are expected to reduce administrative effort per registrant by approximately 50-70%, significantly increasing staff capacity and operational scalability.

Project Deliverables

The core deliverables for this engagement provide the strategic and technical documentation required to sustain SCC's new operations. These include comprehensive As-Is and To-Be Process Maps that detail the workflows for event registration, food pantry operations, and pool attendance. We also delivered Current and Future System Architecture diagrams to visually map the transition to a centralized data model. To secure institutional memory and assist future volunteers, we provided a targeted library of Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)—covering event registration, recurring event setup, and technology governance—alongside step-by-step Implementation Guides for configuring the Zapier automation pipelines and operationalizing Bloomerang's payment integrations.

Recommendations

To ensure long-term success, SCC should adhere to the five-phase implementation roadmap to systematically deploy integrations and standardized workflows. Centralizing all payments within Bloomerang-integrated channels will enable consistent tracking and more reliable reporting across operations and fundraising. Additionally, formalizing technology governance through defined approval tiers will prevent future tool fragmentation and mitigate the risk of uncoordinated or redundant technology adoption. SCC should also transition in-kind technology expenses into the formal operational budget to improve financial visibility and sustainability. Finally, implementing ongoing process reviews, such as post-mortems, will reinforce adoption and support continuous improvement, ensuring that operational gains are maintained over time.

Student Consulting Team

Tor Taepaisitphongse served as Project Manager and led the design and implementation of the team's core technology solutions and strategy deck. He is a third-year student in Information Systems and Statistics & Machine Learning. He will be interning at Amazon this summer as a Business Intelligence Engineer intern.

Zachary Fan handled organizational strategy. He is a third-year student in Information Systems and Computer Science. He will be interning at Meta this summer as a Software Engineering intern and is interested in the intersection of humanity and technology.

Lucas Hazard spearheaded recurring events utilization in Wix to track pool attendance. He is a fourth-year student studying Information Systems. He will be graduating this May, and is currently still in the process of securing a job.